

Virtues

Virtues: +1

Good Characteristic. You may replace any one characteristic with a number derived by making a simple roll and referring to this chart: 1-5: +1, 6-8: +2, 9-10: +3.

Exceptional Talent. The following Exceptional Talents may be purchased as +1 virtues. (Exceptional Talents are available only to those who take them as virtues.) See the Abilities chapter (pp. 40-41) for details: Direction Sense, Empathy, Read Lips, Alchemy, Premonitions, Second Sight, Sense Holiness/Unholiness, Magic Sensitivity, Weather Sense, Hexing, Contortions, Mimicry, Perfect Balance, Healer.

Ambidextrous. You can use either hand equally well. When using two weapons in combat, you only suffer a -1 with each, rather than the standard -1 for the dominant hand and -3 for the off hand.

Animal Companion. You have a loyal, intelligent animal for a companion. Your relationship with it is a meaningful one; you are very close. The animal can at least obey simple commands. If it should die, you would be profoundly distraught.

Arcane Lore. You are privy to Hermetic knowledge, so you can choose Arcane Knowledges (which are normally restricted to magi) as beginning abilities.

Berserk. Any time you lose a body level or wound an enemy, you must make a stress roll and add your Angry score. If you roll a 9+, you experience battle lust and go berserk. The storyguide can also call for a roll when you are strongly frustrated. While berserk, you get +2 on Damage, Soak, and Fatigue rolls, but suffer a -2 penalty on Def; and you cannot retreat, hesitate to attack, or give quarter. Calming down requires a Per - Angry roll of 3+, one roll per round. If you are still berserk while no more enemies are present, you attack your friends.

Clear Thinker. You think clearly and rationally. You get a +3 bonus on all rolls to resist lies, confusion, befuddlement, subterfuge etc., whether these attempts are magical or mundane.

Close Family Ties. Your family is one of the most important things in your life, and they still support and aid you whenever they can, even if it means personal risk. They will not hesitate to do you any favor that is within their power to perform, and can call out their friends and neighbors to help them. It works both ways however; they may call on you for help some day.

Code of Honor. You guide your life by a heartfelt code of honor, probably related to the knightly chivalric code. While it keeps you from taking unfair advantage of others, it also provides a strong moral support because it is more important than petty distractions, such as fear and greed. You get +3 on rolls to resist temptations that would sway

you from your Code, whether magical or mundane.

Common Sense. Whenever you are about to do something counter to common sense, the storyguide has the task of alerting you to what you are doing. This is an excellent virtue for a beginning player, as it legitimizes any kind of help the storyguide may give. It can also be a great source of what really is a sensible course of action in the fantasy universe.

Educated. You may choose Formal Knowledges as beginning abilities.

Enduring Constitution. You can withstand pain and fatigue. Deduct 1 point from each of the negative adjustments in both your body and fatigue levels, so Medium Wounds, for example, means only a -2 penalty. You get +3 on rolls to resist pain.

Faerie Upbringing. The faeries took you when you were a babe, but now you are back among the humans. You feel at home with faeries, magic, and other strange things and have +3 to all your personality rolls when you are dealing with them, but you find human society bizarre, especially religion. You cannot have Social Skills as beginning abilities.

Free Expression. You have the imagination and creativity needed to compose a new ballad or to paint an original painting, and have the potential to be a great artist.

Good Armaments. You can have any standard armament and one expensive armament. (See p. 59.)

Higher Purpose. Let others concern themselves with petty matters, you have a higher goal, such as freeing an occupied people or bringing peace between the Order of Hermes and society — your feelings must be altruistic. Your confidence counts double when pursuing this goal because you see beyond your momentary purposes to a higher end, plus you gain +3 on personality rolls used to pursue this goal.

Keen Vision. Get a +3 bonus to all rolls involving sight.

Knack. You have an innate knack for some specific activity which gives you a +2 on rolls dealing with that activity. Examples include: mechanics, music, bows, swords, woodlands, mountains, cities & towns, languages, noble courts, swamps, etc. Whenever in this environment or pursuing this activity, you get your bonus. A bonus on weapon type applies wherever a skill for those weapons applies; the bonus applies either to parry or to attack skill, your choice. Knacks can be no more broad than those listed here.

Light Sleeper. You can wake up almost immediately when disturbed, and take no penalties the first few rounds of activity. The storyguide may also allow you to make generous Per rolls while you are asleep to see if noises wake you up.

Lithe. You are slightly built but agile. Your Size is -1, but you add +1 to both Dex and Qik. Cross off the "Hurt" body level and the "Winded" fatigue level from your sheet.

Long-Winded. You have a high endurance and gain +3 on all your Fatigue rolls. Magus: The bonus does not apply to casting spells.

Mentor. A person of some importance, wealth, or wisdom has taken an interest in your life, and at times provides you with material aid and advice. The mentor does not necessarily like or even know of your relationship with the covenant. At some point your mentor may have a small favor to ask of you...

Prestigious Family. Your family is well-known and respected. When in dire need, others may help you because of your family ties, or your family itself may provide assistance. You begin the game with a good reputation of your choice at level 2.

Resilient Constitution. You get a +3 bonus on all rolls to recover from wounds.

Self-Confident. You begin the game with 4 Cnf points.

Sharp Ears. Get a +3 bonus to all rolls involving hearing.

Social Contacts. You have a broad range of acquaintances, accumulated over years of travel and socializing. Almost everywhere you go, you meet someone you know, or you know how to get in touch with someone who can help you. Whenever you are somewhere new, you know someone who is in town or in the area if you can make a Pers roll of 10+. You must pick what kind of contacts you have: underworld, noble, merchant, town guard, church, peasants, etc. This virtue may be taken more than once, representing contacts in more than one part of society.

Stocky. You are short but broad and thick. Add +1 to Str.

Strong Personality. For any three personality traits, you may have scores from -6 to +6, instead of the usual -3 to +3.

Strong-willed. You cannot easily be coerced into activities, beliefs, or feelings. You get +3 on any roll which may require strength of will, such as resisting temptation, torture, or the effects of a magical ability or spell that attempts to dominate your will.

Student. You have access to books and possibly teachers from which you can study, and adequate time to do so. You get 1 experience point per season to apply to your knowledges.

Temporal Power. You wield political power in society. You influence leaders and lead common folk. The greater your power, the more responsibility you have, and the harder it is to work with magi unopposed.

Tough. You can take physical punishment better than most people. You get a +3 bonus on your Soak rolls.

Venus' Blessing. You get +3 on Com and Pers rolls with sexually compatible characters in

Flaws

Flaws: -1

Bad Reputation. People in the area know of you and hold you in ill regard. Choose a specific reputation and a location near the covenant. The beginning score of the reputation is 2. The storyguide should be sure to bring the reputation into play; it can make things very interesting.

Black Sheep. You come from a prestigious family, but you have somehow estranged yourself from these relatives. They will have nothing to do with you, unless they feel the need to punish you somehow. Those who might resent your family's power can take safe revenge by beating you up. You begin the game with bad reputation of your choice at level 2.

Compulsion. You have an unfortunate compulsion which causes you problems. Examples: drinking, sex, perfection, bragging, gambling, eating (perhaps you could combine this one with obesity), to champion the grogs, to always get the last word, to "exaggerate" (lie), or to challenge authority.

Criminal Brand. The brand of a criminal has been burned into your cheek, giving a -1 penalty on all rolls involving others' positive reactions to you. You have a reputation (level 1) as a criminal in your old locale. Perhaps some old enemies are still on the watch for you. Magus: N/A. Who cares? You're a wizard.

Cursed. Somehow, for some reason, you are cursed, either magically, divinely, or perhaps through the influence of the dark powers or faeries.

Example -1 Curses:

- Everything you say, that you really mean, is taken in the worst possible way
- Smile, laugh, frown, and cry always in the wrong circumstances
- Can only eat living things
- A toad appears in your mouth when you speak a direct lie
- All food tastes like ashes and drink like stagnant water.
- Music causes you pain, the more beautiful, the more painful.

Dark Secret. You have some secret that haunts you and would lead to shame, rejection, and possibly vengeance if it were discovered. Hints about the secret continually arise, and there might be others who know the secret and could betray you. You cannot imagine that your life could continue as you know it if people knew your secret. This secret makes you avoid certain places, dislike certain people, or fear certain things. A few examples are: your parents are diabolists, you once murdered a knight (or maybe a magus), or you are fleeing from mundane or Hermetic justice.

Deep Sleeper. When you sleep, you don't do it half-way. You can sleep through loud noises and generally only wake up when shaken or

when you're good and ready. Even then you suffer -3 on your rolls for half an hour or so, and you're likely to head back to bed if at all possible.

Delusion. You believe wholeheartedly in something that just isn't so. For example, you might believe that you are a wizard (if you aren't), that round rocks are extremely valuable, that you are the long lost son of the Baron, or that your imaginary friend is actually real.

Diabolic Upbringing. Your parents were diabolists, and, though you have escaped their evil ways, you are still haunted by your upbringing and the memory of acts best left unspoken. The thought of demons fills you with dread and hatred. Hell might maintain a special interest in the "well-being" of your soul.

Disfigured. A visible disfigurement makes you ugly and easy to recognize. Subtract 3 from your Prs rolls that involve good looks, gaining respect, and so on. You doubtless have a cruel nick-name that refers to your unfortunate appearance. Magus: Your disfigurement probably comes from an accident during your apprenticeship. Let your imagination go wild.

Driving Goal. You have some personal goal which you feel compelled to follow, even if it gets you into trouble or jeopardizes the group's goals. Examples: to free the peasants from oppression, to harass and kill Norman warriors, to make everyone regard you as more intelligent than they are, or to amass as much personal wealth as possible. The goal is limitless in its extent, something you can never finally accomplish.

Dutybound. You adhere to a restrictive code of conduct, probably including prohibitions against lying, killing prisoners, stealing, and other occasionally useful actions. Unlike the "Code of Honor" above, you follow this code out of guilt or fear, so it does not provide moral support. You are more likely to spend your energy justifying your conduct than keeping your conduct pure.

Enemies. You have an enemy or enemies who cause you trouble, such as the local baron or bishop, a band of outlaws, or perhaps a really nasty innkeeper. The enemy must be powerful enough to endanger you; make sure you get the troupe's approval.

Evil Eye. One of your eyes is bloated and deformed, casting an evil look across your face. Reduce your Prs by 2 and your Com by 1. People generally regard you as evil, and hide their children's faces from your gaze. The mystic virtue of "Entrancement" would fit well with this flaw.

Faerie Enmity. Faeries hate you and take every opportunity to harm or pester you. Faerie forests are extremely dangerous places for you, but even in rural areas faeries often spoil your food, plague your dreams, or otherwise torment you. Luckily, they prefer

to let you live so they can continue to hassle you.

Fragile Constitution. You suffer a -2 penalty on all rolls to recover from wounds and diseases.

Hatred. You bear an all-consuming hatred for some person who is so powerful that exacting proper vengeance is impractical or impossible. Nevertheless you constantly pursue opportunities to gain power over or hurt the object of your hatred, so much so that your reason is clouded.

Hired Sword (Grog only): You are an experienced mercenary, but you are new at the covenant. You don't know the wizards or their strange ways very well, and you might not fit in with the community of grogs just yet. You cannot have a positive Loyal score (at least as far as the covenant is concerned.)

Infamous Family. You come from a family that is very well known, but not very well liked. You have a bad reputation at level 1, and you will have a particularly hard time losing it because it is seen as a family trait, not a personal one. You have trouble trusting others because others in your community have always been against you.

Judged Unfairly. Somehow you come across wrong to people, and they universally distrust and underestimate you. You catch no one's eyes, impress no one, and can get no one to take you seriously. You might find one exceptional person who somehow sees you as you want to be seen. Cling to that person.

Lost Love. You have lost your true love to death, distance, or marriage. You take little joy in life's pleasures and give up easily in the face of difficulty, since you've already lost the most important struggle. On those occasions when you forget yourself and have a good time, you inevitably feel sorrow afterwards as you think about how it could have been if your true love were with you.

Magic Susceptibility. You are easily affected by magic. You suffer a -3 penalty on all natural resistance rolls and rolls to soak direct damage from magic (opposite of "Withstand Magic" above). If the magic is good, the penalty may become a bonus, as you are more likely to be affected by good magic as well.

Missing Ear. You cannot locate the direction of sounds, -1 to hearing rolls.

Missing Eye. You cannot judge close distances easily and get -2 on missile weapon and thrown weapon rolls at close range. You have a blind side on which people can approach you without you seeing them. In combat you suffer a -1 on Attack rolls because your field of vision is limited.

Missing Foot. You have a wooden peg for a foot; you cannot run quickly and suffer a -3 penalty on rolls that involve walking or balancing on your feet. You also suffer a -1 on Def rolls because you cannot maneuver well.

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appropriate situations. People are often attracted to you; the storyguide should play this out. At times you can put this to good use; other times it's a hassle.

Well-Known. You have a good reputation in a particular area and are well-liked. Choose an appropriate reputation, a specific location near the covenant. You begin at Level 2.

Well-travelled. You have travelled extensively in this part of the world and find it easy to get along with people throughout the land. You are familiar with their dialects or can pick them up quickly (+2 to appropriate speaking rolls), and you know something of local habits and traditions. You get +1 with knowledge rolls connected to being well-traveled, such as Legend Lore.

Virtues: +2

Superior Characteristic. You may replace one characteristic with a number derived by rolling on this chart: 1-5: +2, 6-8: +3, 9-10: +4.

Exceptional Talent. You can take Enchanting Music (p. 40) or Visions (p. 41) as a +2 virtue.

Faerie Blood. Somewhere in your ancestry there is a faerie, and this relation gives you an intuitive grasp of the motivations and personality of faeries. Faeries are more comfortable around you than they are with other humans and, given time, may even forget the mortal blood in your veins. Precise effects are up to the storyguide (and the faeries). Add +1 to all your rolls to avoid losing characteristics to aging, and add +3 to all natural resistance rolls (for those spells you want to resist).

Famous. You have a good reputation with a score of 4 in the area. Choose the specific reputation and pick one or more noteworthy deeds that are a part of this fame.

Knack. As the +1 virtue, but your bonus is +4.

Large. Your Size is +1 instead of 0, which makes you a very large person. This extra size gives you an extra "Hurt" body level and an extra "Winded" fatigue level. (Divide the line for these levels in half with slash marks; both sides must be marked before you drop to the next lowest level.) You also get a +1 bonus to your Str. If your Prs is positive, it increases 1 point; but if it is negative, it decreases 1 point. Magus: +4 Virtue.

Latent Mystical Ability. You have a magical quality that has not yet manifested itself. At some point it might appear, either spontaneously or because of some relevant event, like drinking faerie wine. You have the capacity to become a magus as long as some magical talent does not manifest itself strongly first. You probably do not realize you have this capacity. You, the storyguide, and Whimsy Cards will determine when and how the talent appears. Magus: While developing your magical ability, your master failed to identify some power hidden in you, and it

remains latent.

Light Touch. You have especially good hand-eye coordination and an aptitude for using your hands in precise, fast ways. Gain +3 to all rolls involving subtle use of the hands and fingers (like picking pockets) and roll one less botch roll than you otherwise would. Does not apply to archery.

Magical Animal Companion. You have as a companion a magical animal smart enough to follow your orders. The smaller and more innocuous the creature, the more intelligent it is. A ferret or crow is as intelligent as a human, though it cannot talk, while a wolf is merely very cunning and a horse is simply a bit smarter than normal. Subject to the troupe's approval, you may give it a mystical virtue or two, balancing them normally with flaws of your own. The creature has a Magic Might of +10 minus its Size.

Piercing Gaze. By staring intently at someone, you make them feel uneasy, as if you were staring into their heart and soul. Those with ulterior motives, uneasy consciences, or who are lying must make personality rolls, Guile rolls, or whatever the storyguide deems appropriate to remain calm. Faeries and demons are unfazed by your power.

Reserves of Strength. Once per day, when in need, you can put forth an incredible show of strength. For the duration of the current need, add +4 to your effective strength, and afterwards you must make two Fatigue rolls. You may use this reserve while battling one enemy, lifting one boulder, wrestling one opponent, etc.

Self-Confident. You begin the game with 5 Cnf points.

Superior Armaments. You can have expensive arms and armor.

True Love. You have found true love. Whenever you are suffering, are in danger, or feel dejected, the thought of the one you love will give you strength to persevere (+3 to appropriate personality rolls). When you are threatened with permanent separation from your true love, Cnf used in a roll counts double. In dire need, your true love may even come to try to rescue you. On the other hand, having a true love ties you to your lover, to whom you must return frequently. If any enchantment prevents you from returning to your love, the power of love can probably break it if your true love can reach you.

Withstand Magic. You are innately non-magical and can resist many magic spells. You have a +6 bonus on natural resistance rolls and rolls to soak damage from spells. (See pp. 66-67) You resist good magic as well as bad, so if there is a spell in which a high roll means the magic has affected you (like a healing spell), you suffer a -6 penalty on the roll. You can have no magical powers. Magus: We don't recommend that you take this virtue, since it means you can't use any form of magic.

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Superior Characteristic Pair. You may replace the scores in a characteristic pair with a number rolled on this chart (roll for each characteristic): 1-5: +2, 6-8: +3, 9-10: +4.

Fast Learner. You get an extra experience point each story and an extra experience point per year because of your ability to learn quickly and to pick up ideas faster than normal. You begin the game with 10 extra points with which to purchase abilities. Magus: you get 1 extra point per story and +1 on rolls to study *vis*; +5 Virtue.

Jack-of-All-Trades. You can attempt things that would be more difficult for those who share your lack of training. You suffer no adverse penalties for making skill rolls when you have no score in that skill, provided you have some time to consider what you are about to do.

Self-Confident. You begin the game with 6 Cnf points.

True Faith. Through piety and holy devotion you have received the faith that, it is said, can move mountains. You have 1 Faith point and can gain more, but you have no Cnf points (see p. 141).

Virtues: +4

Extraordinary Characteristic: You may replace one characteristic with a number rolled on this chart: 1-5: +3, 6-8: +4, 9-10: +5.

Exceptional Talent. You can take Entrancement (p. 41) as a +4 Virtue.

Charmed Life. Luck protects you from the worst of injuries and harm. Whenever you botch, you may re-roll the botch dice. Take whichever result of the two botch results is better. For example, if you have rolled three botch dice and gotten a 0 (a botch), you can re-roll all three dice. If there is no 0 in the re-roll, you have not botched, but if you get a 0 on the re-roll as well, you still botch. You must, however, describe in (possibly outrageous) detail how you managed to miss the grave fate that was almost yours. The storyguide should also keep this trait in mind during the story and be more lenient with Whimsy Cards used to rescue or protect you. Magus: This luck does not count for spell-casting; magic is too unpredictable and powerful to be influenced in this manner.

Destiny. Your life is heading toward a definite culmination. Prophecies and dreams may give you clues as to the culmination's nature, but you are not yet sure what it will be. This sense of direction gives you the surety to overcome fear, depression, and discouragement caused by anything not relevant to your destination (and therefore not, in the end, relevant to you); +2 on appropriate rolls. If it ever seems your destiny will fail because of your untimely demise, something

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Oath of Fealty. You owe service to someone or some organization outside the covenant. It could be a lord, the Church, political leaders in a city, or your family. You must justify your actions to those to whom you owe fealty, and sometimes there is a conflict between your activities with the covenant and your oath.

Obese. You are large because of fat, not muscle. Your Size is +1, but you must subtract 2 from Quickness. You also suffer -3 on Fatigue rolls (not including casting spells). You get an extra Hurt body level, but you get no extra fatigue level.

Obsessed. You are obsessed with some prized object, action, or ideal. Examples: You keep your sword with you at all times, polish it hourly, and let no one touch it; you protect the wizards from all dangers, becoming furious when they are insulted or hampered; or you keep yourself spotlessly clean and look down on those who don't do likewise.

Offensive to Animals. You are somehow tainted with magic, and this disturbs animals. Horses will not let you ride them, and dogs growl or cower in your presence. People may well suspect you of being a magus or a devil-worshiper. Magus: N/A, you automatically have this trait already.

Orphan. You have no family. You were either raised by the Church or you simply made your own way on the streets. You are a loner and have trouble working with others. You are also used to a world in which one must be selfish, sneaky, and heartless to survive.

Poor Equipment. You can only have inexpensive arms and armor, though you can have inexpensive equipment relevant to your occupation.

Poor Eyesight. Subtract 3 from rolls involving sight, including using missile weapons. New environments are disorienting and perhaps frightening for you.

Poor Hearing. Subtract 3 from rolls involving hearing. Speech that is hard for others because of the language, dialect, accent, etc. is very difficult for you. You often pretend to be listening to people when indeed you are not.

Poor Memory. You have a bad memory, especially for one thing, such as names, faces, or places. You must make a roll of 6+ to see if you remember anything related to your special difficulty, and you get a -2 on any memory rolls in general. Magus: It takes twice as long to learn spells. You begin the game with half the normal spell Levels. -6 Flaw.

Recruit (Grog only): You have been trained at the covenant, but you have never fought in a real battle. You cannot have a positive Brave score; increasing this score will be important for your character development.

Sensitive. Something that others find unpleasant you find completely intolerable. If you are a violent type, you may start fights with

those who offend you. Examples: impiety, insults to women, poor manners, lack of civilized niceties (such as a warm bed), arrogance.

Short Attention Span. You must earn double experience points to rise in your Knowledge and expend double points to buy them to begin with. Keeping watch, listening to complex orders, following the plot of a story, or performing other tasks that require continued attention are usually not within your ability. Magus: N/A, You'd never have survived apprenticeship.

Simple-Minded. You can only keep your mind on one thing at a time: guarding the bridge, hunting for a missing ring, or hiding in the trees. You become easily confused unless others give you very clear instructions. When unexpected circumstances pop up, you find them difficult to deal with.

Social Handicap. You have some trait that keeps you from interacting easily with other people. Possibilities include body odor, a morose temperament, unworldliness (difficulty understanding such trivial and mundane concerns as money), unclean habits, or outspoken atheism. The trait you choose must impair your social dealings with most people in society, causing penalties of -1 to -3 on appropriate rolls. Magus: N/A, being a magus is a social handicap in and of itself.

Soft Hearted. You cannot bear to witness suffering, and causing it can bring you days of sleepless grief. You avoid danger and try to keep your friends out of it as well. You value life and health so strongly that you would rather give up important goals than have another person risk combat for you. Even the deaths of enemies is painful to you. On the positive side, you are compassionate and easily moved by song and story.

Uncommon Fear. Something that others find innocuous, perhaps disturbing, or even pleasant makes you nervous, edgy, and unable to concentrate. In the presence of the object you fear, the only thing you can comfortably do is get away. The fear object is not something you're likely to meet on a daily basis. If you are prone to violence, you might respond to the thing you fear by attacking or destroying it, but only when you cannot get away. Examples: wild animals, strange sounds, clergy, enclosed spaces, the full moon, the open sea, foreigners, Jews.

Weak Self-Confidence. You begin the game with 1 fewer Cnf point than normal. Not available to grogs.

Weakness. You have a weakness for some object or kind of person. In the face of this thing, all else is unimportant. Promises are forgotten, duties neglected, and common sense defenestrated. Examples: poets & storytellers, a pretty face, alcohol, flattery.

Weak-Willed. Instead of looking to yourself, you look to others for guidance. Those who try to fool, intimidate, or manipulate you gain +3 to their rolls. Take -2 to your rolls to

see if you gain Cnf points. Take a positive Follower trait. What you need more than anything else is to find someone you trust to put all your faith in.

Flaws: -2

Clumsy. You are not very graceful and tend to drop things. Play this up as much as you can, and reduce your Dex by 1 and make an extra botch roll with Dex-related rolls.

Common Fear. As "uncommon fear" above, but the thing that frightens you is common, such as dogs, night, woods, women, men, people in authority, weapons, fire, and so on.

Cursed. You suffer from a severe curse given you by one of the great supernatural powers. Example -2 Curses:

- Stutter uncontrollably when you try to say something important.
- If you ever tell a secret that was entrusted in you, the secret will somehow, in some way, harm you.

Deaf. You cannot hear and can understand speech only if you read lips.

Decrepit. You have 1 Decrepitude point from old wounds or a past serious illness (p. 32).

Gangling. You are scrawny and awkward. Subtract 1 from Str, Prs, and Dex.

Haunted. You are haunted by a ghost that only you can see and hear. It insults, berates, and distracts you, especially when you need to keep your cool. In addition, it often uses one of the following powers against you: take and hide small items; "chill" others and make them ill at ease; cause a buzzing in your or someone else's ears to prevent them from hearing clearly (-3 on hearing rolls); move small items, like knives, to cause them to fall on you, trip you, or otherwise hamper or endanger you; or make eerie noises, such as chains clinking. Yelling at the ghost sometimes drives it away but also confuses those around you. Unless you are exceptionally strong-willed, you sometimes do as the ghost commands to get relief from its hauntings. If you aid the ghost in completing its final purpose, you may be able to get rid of it. The ghost has no powers when more than seven yards away from you. Magus: It is a particularly powerful ghost, so you may have trouble controlling it even with spells. It can interfere with your lab work, -3 on all Lab totals.

Hunchback. You have a deformed body that gives you a grotesque appearance and hinders your movements. Prs is -2, Com is -1, and Dex is -1. Magus: -1 Flaw.

Infamous. The locals know you well and curse you in their prayers. Take a level 4 bad reputation in the local area, and decide what horrible deeds you did to gain such ill will.

Lame. As a cripple either from birth or through some accident, you move slowly and clumsily. Anyone can outrun you. Take -1 to -10 on rolls involving moving quickly or agilely, and -4 on Dodge rolls and -1 on other combat

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somehow will preserve you. Whimsy Cards and storyguide aid are musts to play this out fully. When the time is right, your destiny will be fulfilled, though it may cost you your life.

Failed Apprentice. You began apprenticeship to become a magus, but something keeps you from ever being able to continue your studies. Perhaps your master found that your Gift of magic was incomplete or some grievous mishap robbed you of it altogether. You may have Magic and Formal Knowledge as beginning abilities, and you are familiar with a wizard's life. Wizards welcome you and have compassion for you (those magi who are given to such emotions, anyhow). You may still work for your former master. If your Gift was not completely destroyed, you most likely have some mystic virtues. Magus: N/A

Ghostly Warder. A ghost watches over you. It might be your grandmother, a childhood friend, or anyone else who would care for you enough to stay around you after death. It is invisible and silent to all but you. It can see and hear what is going on around you, and can leave your presence once per day for up to half an hour, making an excellent spy. Each time the ghost leaves your presence, however, roll a stress die to see how well it managed. It needs to roll a 3+ to come back with anything coherent. Below that, it lost touch with the living world and found out nothing. On a botch, it has lost touch with you and never returns. (Make an extra botch roll for each point of the Dominion, infernal power, or faerie power of the area.) Death does not leave people normal, so your ghost no doubt has some quirks that make it less than dependable. The ghost has 20 points of experience in various abilities that it can use to advise you. It might be tempting for the ghost to "encourage" you to join it over on the Other Side.

Magic Resistance. You have an innate +20 Magic Resistance (p. 66), incompatible with a *parma magica* (they're not cumulative) Some physical sign may accompany this resistance, such as a birthmark or iron fingernails.

Redcap. You are a redcap, a messenger of the Order of Hermes. You may be assigned to one covenant or you may wander among the covenants delivering messages, receiving in return a moderate stipend. Strangely enough you are considered a full member of the Order of Hermes; you possess a sigil, and your representatives attend most tribunals (although, out of deference to true magi, they do not vote). Most folk will not harass or harm you, and even magi think twice before hindering your mission. Essentially this gives you a high degree of protection when you travel, even when you travel alone. You may choose Formal and Magic Knowledge as beginning abilities. Magus: +3 Virtue.

Self-Confident. You begin the game with 7 Cnf points.

Ways of the Woods. You have a deep understanding of the woodlands, feeling more natural and at home there than anywhere else. You get a +4 Knack with the woods (see the +2 Virtue). In addition, you suffer one less botch than normal in the woods (but always at least 1), and you get along well with woodland creatures, whether they are mundane or faerie. Particularly vicious creatures may still attack you, but at least they'll accord you with the proper respect.

Wealth. You own land and other valuable things and have a yearly excess income of about 700 silver pennies. You can have a mount of your own and Superior Armaments (a +2 virtue).

Werewolf. When the full moon shines in the night sky, you take the form of a wolf. While you are in your wolf form, add the characteristics listed for wolves in the Bestiary (p. 116) to your own, and add +3 to your Violent trait as well. You also get +8 on your Soak vs. all non-silver and non-magical attacks. Take an ability called Werewolf with a score purchased like any other ability. When you roll a 12+ you may voluntarily take the form of a wolf (one try per day). Your clothes do not

transform with you, and you are not healed when you change. This ability is very rare and mysterious; it is often seen as evil. Invent a good story to explain the origin of your lycanthropy: a bite, a family trait, or a curse. Muto Córporum Level 35.

Virtue: +5

Guardian Angel. You have learned to hear the words of your guardian angel, who gives you practical and spiritual advice. Your angel guides and protect you, so that any time you are doing something of which the angel approves and you roll a 1 in stress, you automatically succeed in the roll (provided the ease factor is 20 or below). The angel whispers in your ear and tells you what is best for you spiritually, which might not be what is best for you materially. When you speak aloud, your angel can hear you, and so you can hold conversations. The angel is aware of your thoughts, but other than that has a limited view of the world. If you act against the angel's moral advice, it may leave you, perhaps until you correct your ways, perhaps forever. The angel approves of violence only when there is a holy reason for it, and that is hard to find.

Instant Grogg

If you want to generate a grog quickly, use the following system.

Age: 20 years old.

Characteristics: Determine normally.

Virtue: Choose one of these- Good Characteristic, Enduring Constitution, +2 Knack w/ favored weapon, Long-Winded, Keen Vision, Resilient Constitution, Sharp Ears, Stocky, Tough.

Flaw: Choose one of these- Criminal Brand, Compulsion, Disfigured, Hired Sword, Missing Ear, Missing Eye, Orphan, Recruit, Short Attention Span, Simple-Minded, Social Handicap.

Personality Traits: Choose normally.

Abilities: Choose the following ability scores.

- One ability with a score of 4
- Two abilities at 3
- Two abilities at 2
- Two abilities at 1

Flaws

rolls specifically. Your base speed is a mere one mile per hour. Decide precisely how and why you are lame.

Missing Hand. You can only use one hand for climbing, combat, and other activities; take a -2 to -4 penalty to any such actions. Magus: You suffer -3 on spell-casting, except for spells you invent specifically for one-handed casting (-2 on Lab Totals to invent such spells).

Mute. You cannot speak, perhaps your tongue was cut off. You probably use rudimentary hand gestures and grunts to get your needs across. Magus: N/A, your master would have restored your voice magically.

Over-Confident. You have an exaggerated and unshakable estimation of your capabilities, and you do not hesitate to try things that promise only defeat. (This is a dangerous flaw where combat is concerned.) If you are convincing in your speech, you can infect others with this over-confidence.

Sheltered Upbringing. You grew up completely separated from society, knowing only your parents or a mentor. Recently you have been introduced to a wondrous new world of strangers, and you are overwhelmed. You are unable to function normally because you cannot understand most human customs, motivations, and mentalities. Take -3 to most tasks involving social interaction, and you may have no Social Talents or Skills as beginning abilities. Depending on your personality, you might react to the world with contempt, fear, or wonder. Eventually you may overcome your upbringing.

Small Frame. Your frame is smaller than average. Size -1, subtract 1 from Str. Body and fatigue levels as for "Lithe" above. Magus: -3 Flaw.

Tainted with Evil. Something you, your parents, or your ancestors did has tainted you with evil. Others naturally feel very ill at ease around you, and people easily to hate you. Gaining a positive reputation is impossible. Magi do not react as strongly to this attribute as normal people. Magus: -1 Flaw, it doesn't matter much what people think of you.

Terrors. Some specific thing fills you with overwhelming dread. You can do nothing but scramble and fight to escape the presence of the terrible thing, and if this is impossible, you are likely to become a pile of quivering pudding. Make the object of your fear common enough that it will come into play, but rare enough that you still have a playable character. Examples: criminals, deep forests, heights, wide open spaces, storms, caves.

Flaws: -3

Cursed. You have been cursed by one of the great supernatural powers.

Examples of -3 Curses:

- Pained by light, the brighter the light, the greater the pain.

- See shapes and phantoms in the night that terrify and incapacitate you.

Fury. A violent temper sometimes overwhelms you, sending you into a destructive, uncontrollable rage. Choose some offense that is likely to bring on your temper, such as being insulted, being hurt, or hearing the Order of Hermes disparaged. You must roll 9+ one a stress die or fly into a rage, and you can attempt a similar roll every round to try to calm yourself. While enraged, you get +3 to damage but -1 on all other rolls, and you must make a Fatigue roll every round. Such a furious temper may well be the result of a curse.

Noncombatant. You cannot learn any combat skills and suffer -2 on all Attack and Damage rolls. You cannot pick the Background Flaw of Poor Equipment. Magus: -2 Flaw.

Sense of Doom. You have gained knowledge best left uncovered, perhaps a vision of your demise or eternal fate, perhaps secrets about your true nature. At times you are listless, as no ambition could shake this sense of doom. Whenever you are defeated somehow, whether in combat or a more mundane effort, you become incapable of taking any energetic actions for up to a day. If forced to defend yourself at this time, you suffer -2 on rolls, and you are incapable of using your Cnf points.

Flaws: -4

Cursed. You have been terribly cursed by one of the great supernatural powers.

Examples of -4 Curses:

- Doomed to be wounded in every battle in which you partake (and in many that you try to avoid).
- Your wounds bleed horribly, so that for each unbandaged wound you have, you lose one fatigue level per round, and then lose body levels once you are unconscious.
- Normal tools (including weapons) often break when you try to use them.
- The touch of sunlight burns painfully (lose one body level per minute).

Demon Plagued. You have come to the special attention of a minor demon, who is set on capturing your soul and making your life a living hell in the meantime. This demon has a specialty that it uses against you, such as rage, greed, sloth, or dishonesty. The demon can use its powers directly against you and on others to harm you. For instance, a demon of lies could make you lie or make others lie to you. The demon is too busy (or lazy) to harass you constantly, so it usually only affects you during important times in your life (like adventures). The story guide should keep in mind the subtle nature and sinister purpose of the demon's plans.

Secretly you wonder what evil (or good) you or your family has done to de-

serve such a fate. For overcoming magic resistance, assume the demon has +12 on its magic penetration roll, though it may grow in power or be replaced by a superior demon if it fails to carry out its plans. Magus: Hell takes a special interest in magi; the fiend's Demon Might is at least 24. Don't forget the attendant problems this might cause you in the Order.

Feral Upbringing. You grew up in the wilderness, either being raised by wild animals or on your own. Now that you have come to society (or the covenant), you have learned to understand some basic spoken phrases, but normal human life is still a mystery that you want no part of. As beginning abilities, you may only choose those that you could have learned in the wilds. You may have picked up a few skills at the covenant, such as how to use a mace instead of a club, but you have neither the inclination nor the capacity to learn more refined skills. You have no "Speak Own Language" ability. Magus: N/A

Midget/Dwarf. You are the size of a child, and though your muscles are mature, you lack the leverage that benefits larger folk. Size is -2; subtract 2 from Str. Your comfortable walking speed is two-thirds normal. Even if you are strong, leverage prevents you from using any weapons that require a positive Str. Cross off the "Hurt" and "Medium Wounds" body levels and the "Winded" and "Tired" fatigue levels from your sheet.

Flaws: -5

Blind. You have no or almost no sight. Use of missile weapons is close to futile, reading is impossible, and navigation in unknown territory is difficult. Magus: N/A, your master would have restored your vision magically. It's that important.

Enfeebled. You cannot exert yourself for longer than a few seconds. Any need for rapid movement, such as combat or a chase, leaves you helpless. Long hikes are likewise beyond your capability. You are unable to learn combat skills, since you cannot train in them. Magus: You lose double fatigue levels from casting spells, -6 Flaw.



Hermetic Virtues & Flaws (Magi Only)

It is a rare magus whose natural Gift for magic perfectly fits the structured theory of Hermetic magic, and almost all magi therefore have Hermetic flaws. To simulate this, at least half of your flaws should be Hermetic, rather than chosen from the general list. The following Virtues & Flaws are only for magi – however a magus can choose from the general list as well.

Virtues: +1

Book-Learner. You have a knack for figuring out what people mean when they write about magic, for reading between the lines. Treat all magic books that you study as if they were 2 levels higher than they really are.

The Gentle Gift. The ability to work magic at all is called the "Gift," and it usually disturbs normal people and animals. That is why magi suffer -3 on rolls involving normal people trusting them. But yours is a "gentle Gift"; it does not bother people or animals and you do not suffer this penalty.

Hermetic Prestige. Because of your famous and well-respected master, other magi look up to you even if you haven't earned their respect. Some envy you, and most expect more from you than they would from other magi.

Inventive Genius. You receive +3 on rolls for inventing new spells, crafting magic items, and inventing your longevity potion. If you experiment, you get +6.

Magical Affinity. You have a talent (like an ordinary ability) in a specific kind of magic, and you may add your score in this talent to all spell rolls and lab totals involving this kind of magic. You buy this talent along with your other abilities and can gain experience in it as you can any other talent. Affinities are important because you cannot

assign experience points to your arts, but you can assign them to an affinity. Example +1 Affinities: fighting demons, water creatures, ghosts & corpses, death & aging, wind, self-transformation. Anything broader must be classified as a +2 Affinity.

Mastered Spells. You have 20 experience points that you can use to master spells (see p. 68).

Special Circumstances. You are able to perform magic better in certain circumstances, gaining a +3 bonus to your rolls to cast spells or resist them. Example circumstances: during a storm, while in the air, while touching the target.

Virtues: +2

Free Study. You are better at figuring things out for yourself than you are at studying from books. You gain +1 on your rolls when studying from *vis*.

Magical Affinity. Like the +1 Virtue, but covering broader types of magic. Example +2 Affinities: healing, forests & forest animals, faeries, passions, and rock. Anything more comprehensive than these examples must be classified as at least a +3 Affinity.

Virtue: +3

Magical Affinity. Like the +1 Virtue, but covering broader types of magic. You can use this affinity as a bonus on any form, such as Terram or Mentem.

Virtue: +4

Magical Affinity. As the +1 Virtue, but covering broader types of magic. You can use this affinity as a bonus on any one technique, such as Creo or Perdo.

Flaws: -1

The Blatant Gift. Your Gift (the ability to do magic) is easily noticed by others. You suffer -6 on rolls involving the trust of normal people, and animals are extremely disturbed, frightened, and possibly enraged by your presence. People immediately realize there is something strange about you, even if they do not realize you are a magus. (You must have led a lonely life even before becoming an apprentice.)

Deleterious Circumstances (Uncommon & Minor). Your magic rolls are at -5 in certain uncommon circumstances, such as being in a large city or underground.

Infamous Master. Your master is widely despised or held in contempt, and most magi expect little better from you. Even if you've done nothing out of the ordinary, other magi treat you as if you don't deserve to be among their number. Your master could have been a diabolist, a bumbler, or a fool. You have a bad reputation of the appropriate type, Level 2, among magi.

Loose Magic. You lack the concentration, will, or ability to master spells (see p. 68).

Minor Magic Deficiency (Rare). You have trouble with a particular art, and it is treated as one-half its true value, rounded down. (Treat the art normally when studying.) For example, if you have a score of 9, it acts as if it were 4, but you still could not learn from a book with a score of 6. Don't choose Corporeum, or Vim, or a technique.

Necessary Condition. In order for your magic to work, you must do something that is (thankfully) relatively easy to do. For instance, maybe your magic only works if you sing or if you spin around once.

and flaws that somehow work against each other can create an interesting inner struggle for your character, such as a Compulsion to Drink that can conflict with being Dutybound. Virtues & Flaws that are directly contradictory, as well as those that deal directly with the same aspect of your character, are mutually exclusive. You cannot have Poor Eyesight and Keen Vision, or be Lithe as well as Obese. Neither can you be Large and Stocky, since they both describe your body type. Likewise, you cannot have both a Knack for picking pockets and a Light Touch, since they cover essentially the same kinds of endeavor. Some flaws are perverse versions of virtues, in which case the two are mutually exclusive. For instance, Dutybound describes those who think they have a true Code of Honor, but do not. Sometimes you will take more than one virtue or flaw that refer to the same aspect of your character. You might have a Driving Goal to overthrow a local baron, and a Hatred of that baron. In such a case, they combine effects and make you much more obsessed with killing this baron than you would be if you chose only one of these flaws.

Explaining your virtues and flaws to the other players and to the storyguide allows them to interact with your character more appropriately.

Size

Unless you chose an appropriate virtue or flaw, your size is 0, the adult average (remember that 0 is average for most things). Size determines the number of body and fatigue levels a creature has. It is added to your Soak total (used to absorb weapon damage) and subtracted from your Defense total (used to avoid being struck in combat). Size can also, at the storyguide's discretion, influence such rolls as Stealth and Intimidation. The Size score is more important for comparing different types of creatures than for comparing individuals of one type. The Size Table gives some standards for Sizes.